

Tarkir Dragonstorm Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

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Dataset Snapshot

This run uses 126,902 unique deck builds and 552,428 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 7 learned archetypes. The best-performing large shells are Mardu Go-Wide | Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade, Temur | Temur Tawnyback / Dispelling Exhale, Temur Beast | Temur Tawnyback / Mammoth Bellow, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and build-around incentives.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype			Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Mardu	Go-Wide		30,778	137,924	56.61%	Mardu Devotee, Shock Brigade, Bearer of Glory, Salt Road Packbeast, Fortress Kin-Guard
Mardu	Devotee	/				
Shock Brigade						
Temur		Temur Tawnyback / Dispelling Exhale	13,648	59,848	56.55%	Temur Tawnyback, Dispelling Exhale, Karakyk Guardian, Temur Devotee, Sibsig Appraiser
Temur	Beast		14,195	62,038	54.74%	Temur Tawnyback, Mammoth Bellow, Dragonclaw Strike, Piercing Exhale, Temur Devotee
Temur	Tawnyback	/				
Mammoth Bellow						
Jeskai		Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	18,678	79,539	54.53%	Monastery Messenger, Jeskai Devotee, Narset's Rebuke, Jeskai Monument, Jeskai Shrinekeeper
Sultai		Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	20,838	89,622	54.45%	Lie in Wait, Sultai Devotee, Gurmag Nightwatch, Ainok Wayfarer, Kheru Goldkeeper
Abzan	Counters		17,338	75,079	53.47%	Abzan Devotee, Trade Route Envoy, Kin-Tree Nurturer, Armament Dragon, Stalwart Successor
Abzan Devotee	/	Trade Route Envoy				

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	11,427	48,378	53.20%	Boulderborn Dragon, Dragonstorm Globe, Dragonstorm Forecaster, Breaching Dragonstorm, Dragonbroods' Relic

2 What Defines the Best Shells

Mardu Go-Wide | Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade

This cluster contains 30,778 decks across 137,924 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.61%. Its defining cards are Mardu Devotee, Shock Brigade, Bearer of Glory, Salt Road Packbeast, Fortress Kin-Guard, Coordinated Maneuver.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Temur | Temur Tawnyback / Dispelling Exhale

This cluster contains 13,648 decks across 59,848 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.55%. Its defining cards are Temur Tawnyback, Dispelling Exhale, Karakyk Guardian, Temur Devotee, Sibsigs Appraiser, Riverwalk Technique.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Temur Beast | Temur Tawnyback / Mammoth Bellow

This cluster contains 14,195 decks across 62,038 games and posts a baseline win rate of 54.74%. Its defining cards are Temur Tawnyback, Mammoth Bellow, Dragonclaw Strike, Piercing Exhale, Temur Devotee, Sagu Pummeler.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Jeskai | Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee

This cluster contains 18,678 decks across 79,539 games and posts a baseline win rate of 54.53%. Its defining cards are Monastery Messenger, Jeskai Devotee, Narset's Rebuke, Jeskai Monument, Jeskai Shrinekeeper, Riverwheel Sweep.

The strongest positive links in the shell are Jeskai Revelation + Monastery Messenger, Effortless Master + Highspire Bell-Ringer. The build-around detector flags Highspire Bell-Ringer,

Monastery Messenger, Effortless Master as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

3 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Ugin, Eye of the Storms	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	20.30 pp	73.51%	736
Jeskai Revelation	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	20.22 pp	73.42%	760
Ureni, the Song Unending	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	18.53 pp	71.74%	881
Marang River Regent	Temur Temur Tawnyback / Dispelling Exhale	16.81 pp	73.36%	1978
Elspeth, Storm Slayer	Abzan Counters Abzan Devotee / Trade Route Envoy	14.73 pp	68.19%	698
Dragonback Assault	Temur Temur Tawnyback / Dispelling Exhale	14.45 pp	71.00%	1507
Sonic Shrieker	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	12.01 pp	65.21%	3001
Sage of the Skies	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	11.80 pp	66.33%	2477
Roar of Endless Song	Temur Beast Temur Tawnyback / Mammoth Bellow	11.71 pp	66.45%	3395
Revival of the Ancestors	Abzan Counters Abzan Devotee / Trade Route Envoy	9.64 pp	63.11%	3399
Betor, Kin to All	Abzan Counters Abzan Devotee / Trade Route Envoy	9.55 pp	63.02%	1644
Defibrillating Current	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	9.13 pp	63.58%	162

4 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Highspire Bell-Ringer	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	10.0 / 10	18.24 pp	3869
Monastery Messenger	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	10.0 / 10	11.60 pp	10380
Effortless Master	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	9.1 / 10	11.10 pp	4172

5 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Monastery Messenger	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	0.356	0.93 pp	11474
Jeskai Revelation	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	0.356	18.10 pp	2653
Effortless Master	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	0.330	-0.04 pp	4582
Highspire Bell-Ringer	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	0.330	0.13 pp	4255
Sagu Pummeler	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	0.187	1.89 pp	11776
Lie in Wait	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	0.187	5.03 pp	10773
Salt Road Packbeast	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	2.13 pp	24345
Shock Brigade	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	-1.04 pp	23971
Mardu Devotee	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	0.38 pp	23596
Fortress Kin-Guard	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	-0.33 pp	21341
Bearer of Glory	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	-1.88 pp	20180
Coordinated Maneuver	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.000	0.32 pp	16755

6 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Jeskai Revelation	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	10.0 / 10	5.97 pp	mythic
Marang River Regent	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	10.0 / 10	5.61 pp	rare
Roar of Endless Song	Temur Beast Temur Tawnyback / Mammoth Bellow	10.0 / 10	3.76 pp	rare
Revival of the Ancestors	Abzan Counters Abzan Devotee / Trade Route Envoy	10.0 / 10	2.76 pp	rare
Ureni, the Song Unending	Temur Beast Temur Tawnyback / Mammoth Bellow	9.9 / 10	4.51 pp	mythic
Jeskai Shrinekeeper	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	9.9 / 10	1.05 pp	uncommon
Fangkeeper's Familiar	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	10.0 / 10	2.21 pp	rare
Sage of the Skies	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	9.9 / 10	3.47 pp	rare
Riverwheel Sweep	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	9.9 / 10	0.99 pp	uncommon
Awaken the Honored Dead	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	9.9 / 10	1.61 pp	rare
Sibsig Appraiser	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	9.8 / 10	1.17 pp	common
Sonic Shrieker	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	10.0 / 10	1.45 pp	uncommon

7 Most Striking Positive Pairs

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Jeskai Revelation, Monastery Messenger	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	3.17	79.73%	597
Lie in Wait, Sagu Pummeler	Sultai Lie in Wait / Sultai Devotee	1.32	65.64%	1464
Effortless Master, Highspire Bell-Ringer	Jeskai Monastery Messenger / Jeskai Devotee	0.96	62.61%	444

8 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pair	Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Dalkovan Packbeasts, Reigning Victor	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.43	51.46%	859
All-Out Assault, Rally the Monastery	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.40	51.92%	104
Bearer of Glory, Shocking Sharpshooter	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.38	52.72%	1413
Fortress Kin-Guard, Zurgo's Vanguard	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.35	51.98%	1414
All-Out Assault, War Effort	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.35	52.10%	119
Embermouth Sentinel, Roamer's Routine	Five-Color Dragons Boulderborn Dragon / Dragonstorm Globe	0.33	46.32%	190
Descendant of Storms, Reigning Victor	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.32	51.18%	893
Inevitable Defeat, Zurgo's Vanguard	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.32	52.36%	233
Coordinated Maneuver, Underfoot Underdogs	Mardu Go-Wide Mardu Devotee / Shock Brigade	0.31	52.12%	1531
Abzan Monument, Formation Breaker	Abzan Counters Abzan Devotee / Trade Route Envoy	0.31	48.18%	220

9 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. The strongest cards show up in the bomb table because they win on their own. The cards that pull a cluster together show up in the build-around and dependency tables because they need a shell. The pair and anti-synergy sections then explain which combinations reinforce a winning plan and which combinations look attractive in draft but underperform together.